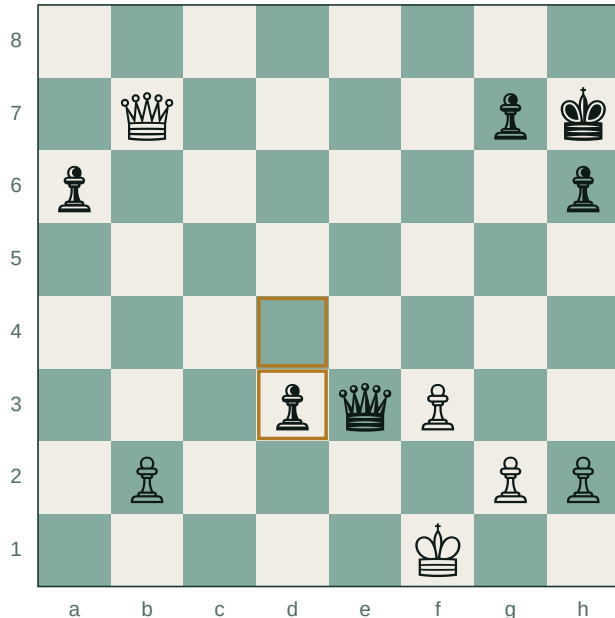


Queen-ending tactics: White, move 38

Queen-ending tactics

White to move



Previous move: 37...d3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Qe4+ Qxe4 39. fxe4

38.Qe4+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. From e4 it attacks king on h7 and queen on e3. Recorded reply: **38...Qxe4**.

39.fxe4 The pawn captures the queen on e4.

At the end, nominal material is White 4 / Black 4 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from +0 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A favorable-looking queen exchange can lead to a drawn pawn ending. Evaluate the new ending before simplifying.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Queens combine long-range checks with promotion support. King shelter and the order of checks often matter more than a small material lead.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect perpetual-check possibilities, queen trades, and checks that gain a tempo for a passed pawn.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on g7.